The thesis holds if privacy demand turns into fees that customers pay repeatedly

What has to be true	*Evidence today*	*What would prove it*
Privacy expands crypto's market	$310B in stablecoins; payroll and OTC deployments reported by Zama and Bron	Issuers and chains reporting a growing share of confidential volume
Products are usable	Security guarantees, cost and ease of use are still early	Confidential transfers available by default in mainstream wallets at costs close to public transfers
Privacy holds users	a16z argues users stay in private ecosystems because moving out risks leaking information	Users and balances retained in private environments over time
Demand is paid for repeatedly	Mostly pilots and token emissions today	Recurring fees; for UR, operator payments rising as SN25 emissions fall

What we will watch for UR

Operator payments against SN25 emissions, the number of paying operators, and coverage by region.

Sources: a16z, Privacy trends for 2026; Variant, Privacy infrastructure trade-offs; Multicoin Capital, 2026 investment thesis; Zama and Bron.